

# Kisoo Kim

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## Appointment

**Vanderbilt University**

July 2026 -

Postdoctoral Research Associate, Center for Effective Lawmaking

Department of Political Science

**University of Virginia**

July 2025 - June 2026

Postdoctoral Research Associate, Center for Effective Lawmaking

## Education

**The University of Chicago**, Ph.D. in Public Policy 2025

**The University of Chicago**, M.A. in Public Policy 2022

**California Institute of Technology**, M.Sc. in Social Science 2018

**Rice University**, B.A. in Economics, B.A. in Mathematics 2015

## Research Interest

American politics, state and local politics, democratic institutions, political economy, legislative politics, electoral competition, democratic accountability, media politics

## Publication

An Information-Based Explanation for Partisan Media Sorting (with Anthony Fowler), *Journal of Theoretical Politics*, 2022

Winner of Ostrom Award given to the best article published in the journal within the previous two calendar years (2021, 2022) from the Formal Theory Section of the American Political Science Association

## Working Paper

Lame Duck by Primary: Effects of Electoral Incentives on U.S. House Representatives (Job Market Paper) *R&R, Quarterly Journal of Political Science*

Winner of Virginia Gray Graduate Student Research Award from the Political Organizations and Parties Section of the American Political Science Association

Reaching the Unreached: Radio, Voting, and Representation in Interwar America *Under Review*

Does the Electoral College Foster Polarization? Turnout and Opposition Demobilization *Under Review*

The Rigidity of Legislative Positions: Incumbents Do Not Respond to Extreme Challengers  
Strategic Media Bias

The Source of the Majority Advantage in Legislative Effectiveness: Separating Cartel Power from  
Unified Government in U.S. State Legislatures

Television and the Majority-Party Premium in Postwar Congress

Bills That Never Reached the Floor: Recovering Negative Agenda Control from Text

Money Follows the Winner: Office Premiums and Access-Seeking Across the Donor Spectrum in  
U.S. House Elections

Seeing Your Representative: Which Accountability Channels Does Local Television Activate?

Prices Without Rents: What an Election Delivers (and Doesn't) to Donor Firms

## Work in Progress

What Term Limits Move: Effort, Positions, and the Dynamics of State Legislatures (with Craig  
Volden and Alan Wiseman)

Newspapers and Legislative Effectiveness in the U.S. House (with Craig Volden and Alan Wiseman)

Legislative Earmarks, Executive Discretion, and the Partisan Targeting of Federal Grants

Commitment or Reputation? Online Publication of Roll-Call Records and the Stability of Legislative Positions

Being Watched: Gavel-to-Gavel Broadcasting and Monitoring in State Legislatures

Social Media and Civic Engagement: Facebook's College-by-College Rollout and Students' Political Participation

Algorithmic Screening and Political Participation: Child-Welfare Investigations and Parents' Turnout

## Selected Teaching Experiences

**Instructor at the University of Virginia**

Politics of Public Policy

2026

**Instructor at the University of Chicago**

Mathematical Methods in Social Science

2022, 2021

## Teaching Assistant at the University of Chicago

|                                                              |                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Statistics for Data Analysis II: Regressions                 | Winter, 2025           |
| Data and Programming for Public Policy                       | Spring, 2024           |
| Game Theory (Ph.D.)                                          | Fall, 2023, 2022, 2021 |
| Applied Econometrics                                         | Fall, 2023             |
| Microeconomics (Ph.D.), Professor Scott Ashworth             | Winter, 2022           |
| Formal Models of Domestic Politics, Professor Scott Gehlbach | Winter, 2021           |
| Political Economy 1, 2 (Ph.D.)                               | 2019                   |
| Microeconomics for Public Policy                             | Spring, 2019           |

## Conferences and Presentations

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2026, 2025, 2024, 2023, 2022

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2025, 2024, 2023

American Politics Workshop, University of Chicago Department of Political Science, 2024, 2023, 2021

Political Economy Lunch, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy, October 2024, April 2024

Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology, July 2024

American Politics Conference, University of Chicago Center for Effective Government, June 2024

Junior Americanist Workshop Series (JAWS), April 2024

Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Annual Conference, March 2024

Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting, January 2024

Science Talk, Korean-American Scientists and Engineers Association Chicago, November 2023

Stigler Lunch Workshop, University of Chicago Booth School of Business, January 2023

Junior Scholar Symposium, Formal Theory Section of American Political Science Association, October 2021

## Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Early Career Fellowship, Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior<br>Section of American Political Science Association            | 2026 - 2027 |
| Virginia Gray Graduate Student Research Award, Political Organizations and<br>Parties Section of American Political Science Association | 2024        |
| Korean Honor Scholarship, The Embassy of The Republic of Korea                                                                          | 2024        |

|                                                                                     |             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| The Woowahan Vendors' Children Scholarship,                                         | 2024        |
| Funded by the founder of Woowa Brothers in South Korea                              |             |
| Korean-American Scientists and Engineers Association Graduate Scholarship           | 2024        |
| Prestage-Cook Travel Award, Southern Political Science Association                  | 2024        |
| Travel Funding, University of Chicago Center for Effective Government               | 2024        |
| Funding for Social Science Research Using Data, Underscore                          | 2023        |
| Grad Council Individual Stipend, University of Chicago Graduate Council             | 2023        |
| Professional Development Fund, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy | 2023        |
| Ostrom Award, Formal Theory Section of American Political Science Association       | 2023        |
| Stigler Center Dissertation Award, University of Chicago Booth School of Business   | 2022        |
| Graduate Fellowship, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy           | 2019 - 2025 |
| Merit Scholarship, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy             | 2018 - 2019 |
| Graduate Fellowship, California Institute of Technology                             | 2016 - 2017 |
| Ando Momofuku Award, Nissin Food Products Co., Ltd.                                 | 2011        |
| Honorable Mention, Nomura Research Institute Policy Essay Contest                   | 2011        |
| Japanese Ministry of Education and Technology Scholarship                           | 2011        |
| Suzaki Foundation Scholarship                                                       | 2009        |

## Service

Referee: *Quarterly Journal of Political Science*

Discussant: American Political Science Association Annual Meeting 2024

## Skills and Information

R, Stata, Python, SQL, PHP, JavaScript, HTML, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X

Served 2 years of military service in the Republic of Korea Army

Last updated: August 2026